

upon contact, we will ask you to provide financial statements or any other reasonable substantiation to display your current funding status.

- Choose your GitLab product
- How many seats are you requesting
- Do you want to purchase support (checkbox)
- Marketing email opt-in (checkbox)

For reasons relating to trade controls, we are unable to accept applicants from Cuba, Iran, Syria, North Korea, Russia, Belarus, or Ukraine.

Legal agreement

GitLab for Startups Program members are subject to the same terms and conditions as regular GitLab customers, since this program only grants them 12 months of GitLab Ultimate for free. When the promotion period ends, startups will have the option of becoming regular paid customers.

Verification flow

Here are some common workflows associated with managing the program, including qualifying a startup:

Review application within

- Startups Issue Board

Scenario: User did not submit complete application

In GitLab Service Desk:

1. Navigate to the Support-Macros Use the the "Funding Info" macro.

Then, in Salesforce:

1. Open lead / contact in the ticket
2. Ctrl F "Startups Program Status"
3. Change the status to Funding Docs Requested

User-submitted application with link to Crunchbase or funding Status (Complete Application)

Seed Stage Flow

If funding amount is less than \$5 million USD, startup is deemed Seed Stage. Follow this flow.

In GitLab Service Desk:

1. Apply the Seed stage macro to send welcome email to customer
2. Insert a coupon code from the coupon code sheet within the macro
3. Review Name and other fields to ensure correctly completed

Then, in Salesforce:

1. Open lead / contact in the Service Desk ticket
2. Ctrl F "Startups Program Status"
3. Change to "Qualified" Seed Y1

Early Stage Flow

If funding amount is less than \$20 Million USD and greater than \$5 million USD, startup is deemed Early Stage.

Follow this flow.

In GitLab Service Desk:

1. Apply the Early Stage macro
2. Set ticket status to Open

Use the Sales Case Routing Sheet

This sheet can be found [Here](#)

- Follow the steps provided via the Sales Case Routing to decide on what stage you will qualify these Startup Companies.

These are types of qualifications that Startups can land under:

- Seed Year 1
- Seed Year 2
- Early Stage Year 1
- Early Stage Year 2

Then, in Salesforce:

1. Open lead / contact in the Service Desk ticket
2. Ctrl+F to find "Startups Program Status"
3. Change to "Qualified" Early Y1
4. Convert the Lead to an Opp
5. Rename the Opportunity as Customer Name, Seats, License Type, Startups - Early - Y(1)
6. Chatter Mktgops to assign the correct account executive
7. Once the account executive has been confirmed, handoff the customer via the Service desk Ticket

For more clarification regarding Startups sales process, please refer to this [highspot page](#)

If they do not qualify, send them the Startups:: Rejection macro and offer to connect them to sales via the Sales handoff process.

SECTION: marketing/developer-relations/community-programs/education-program/_index.md

About

GitLab's Education program is part of the Community Programs team.

On this page, you'll find information about the GitLab for Education Program Team, our vision, our methods, our initiatives, and our program requirements.

The primary mission of the GitLab for Education Program is to facilitate and drive the adoption of GitLab at educational institutions around the globe and build an engaged community of GitLab evangelists and contributors in the next generation of the workforce.

Additionally, the Education Program seeks to evangelize the benefits of an all-remote operating model and GitLab's associated company values with students.

How to reach us

DRI: @janasenap

Email: education@gitlab.com

Additionally, see the following Slack channels.

Channel	Purpose
[community-programs]	Communication regarding the GitLab for Education, GitLab for Open Source, and GitLab for Startups Programs.
[gitlab-for-campuses]	This channel is for discussing the GitLab for Campuses (paid) offering

Vision and goals

The vision of the GitLab for Education Program is to enable educational institutions to be successful in teaching, learning, conducting research with GitLab.

We seek to build an engaged community of GitLab users around the world who actively contribute to GitLab and each other's success, and ultimately become evangelists of GitLab in the workplace and beyond.

Our goals are:

- Align the program structure and license offerings with the needs and operating models of educational institutions while providing the best GitLab has to offer to students, faculty, and staff.

- Grow the base of educational institutions, students, faculty, and staff using GitLab.

- Build a robust and engaged educational community full of members who collaborate, contribute, and enable each other to be successful with GitLab.

- Build meaningful relationships with the Education Program member institutions.

- Provide a wealth of resources for adopting GitLab in an educational setting including course materials, case studies, code examples, syllabi, and presentations.

- Evangelize the benefits of DevOps as a discipline and GitLab as the leading single application for the DevOps lifecycle.

- Bring DevOps into the classroom in related disciplines such as computer science and infrastructure technology.

Be a thought leader in the discipline of DevOps by engaging with related academic disciplines, academic organizations, and associations.

Evangelize the benefits of an all-remote operating model and GitLab's associated company values to the next generation of the workforce.

What we're working on

GitLab for Education Program issues typically exist in the Education Program subgroup of the Developer Relations Group.

But they may also reside in Field Marketing, Corporate Marketing, or other marketing subgroups.

Work labels

We use the following labels to track our work across these spaces.

| Label | Use |

|-----|-----|

|Education Program| General label for all issues related to program management|

|edu-feedback| Marks issues that contain feedback from program and community members|

|OKR | Related to OKRs for the quarter |

|Education:: EAB| Related to the Education Advisory Board |

|edu-conference| Related to conferences the education team is involved with|

|edu-evangelism| Related to the education Evangelist|

|edu-stakeholder-mtng| Used for meetings with members of the outside education community|

OKRS and KPIs

We track progress on OKRs using the Education Program and OKR labels.

The GitLab for Education Program has quarterly OKR in order to measure impact and drive program improvement.

See the FY25-Q4 Developer Relation & Strategy OKRs for more details.

How to help

Alumni are an important part of every school's community.

You can assist the GitLab for Education team by connecting GitLab to your alma mater.

To get started:

Email former professor you really liked and share information about our GitLab for Education Program. Email template coming soon.

Contact your alumni association about "Alumni updates" and share what you do at GitLab.

Contact student organizations you were part of, especially if as related to software or digital technology in some way.

Offer to visit your alma mater virtually to give an "Introduction to DevOps guest lecture"

GitLab for Education Program

In order to qualify for the GitLab for Education Program, applicants must meet the GitLab for

Education Program Requirements.

Once accepted in the program, institutions must agree to and are subject to the GitLab for Education Program Agreement.

GitLab for Education Program requirements

In order to qualify for the GitLab for Education Program, applicants must:

Be a qualified educational institution: A qualified educational institution is one that has been accredited by an authorized agency within its applicable local, state, provincial, federal, or national government and has the primary purpose of teaching its enrolled students. Qualified educational institutions can be public or private and must be non-profit/non-commercial. For reasons relating to trade controls, we are unable to accept applicants from Cuba, Iran, Syria, North Korea, Russia, Belarus, or Ukraine.

Meet the use case requirements: The GitLab educational license can be used solely for the purposes of instructional use or non-commercial academic research. Instructional use includes activities related to learning, training, research and development. Non-commercial academic means conducting not-for-profit research projects conducted by the program member, and not at the request of a third party, which are not intended to, or in fact, produce results, works, services, or data for commercial use by anyone to generate revenue, or for the benefit of a third party. The GitLab educational license cannot be used for commercial, professional, or any other for-profit purposes. Specifically, it is not authorized for use to run, administer, or operate an institution.

Be a full-time faculty or staff member at the qualified educational institution: We can only issue licenses to full-time faculty or staff who are directly employed full-time at the educational institution. Students who may also be employed in a staff role cannot apply.

Please note: the decision to issue a GitLab license via the GitLab for Education Program is always at the discretion of GitLab.

If you have questions on the application and decision making process, please contact education@gitlab.com.

Examples of educational institutions that qualify

K-12 institutions include Elementary, Middle, and High Schools, which may include both publicly and privately funded institutions (Note: GitLab.com (SaaS software) is not available to K-12 institutions. However, K-12 institutions may apply for GitLab self-managed instances.)

Junior Colleges, Community Colleges, and Technical Schools

Universities

Research Institutes or Centers directly owned and operated by a University

Examples of entities that do not qualify

Training centers

Churches and libraries

Medical research centers or institutions associated with a hospital or health care system

Independent research laboratories

Re-training programs

Military schools, institutes, or training centers within a branch of the military

Research institutes or National Laboratories that are owned by a Federal Government

eLearning platforms not directly affiliated with or operated by an accredited academic University

Coding academies, bootcamps, or independent learning platforms

Examples of acceptable use cases

Classroom use: All activities related to the instruction of students in the classroom

Non-commercial academic research: Activity related to not-for-profit research projects at an educational institution that are not conducted for the benefit of a third party.

Organizational use: Activity related to a club or organization at an educational institution as related to the development of students; this could include open source student clubs, robotic clubs, engineering clubs or the like. Note that the non-acceptable use cases still apply to clubs and organizations.

Examples of non-acceptable use cases

Information technology/professional use: Use for maintaining or running the infrastructure, technology or otherwise, of the institution

Administrative use: Use for any administrative functions of the institution including program management, planning, marketing, and service delivery

Commercial research: Research conducted by any commercial programs or entities operated by or affiliated with the educational institution for a commercial purpose.

Third party directed research: For example, the US Government may open a request for proposals for a specific project with a well-defined results. Research laboratories, owned and operated by a University such as an Advanced Research Laboratory (ARL), may apply and be awarded the project in the form of a contract. This type of work, with the goal of benefitting a third party through producing a given outcome, rather contributing to the general body of scientific research itself, does not qualify. An Advanced Research Laboratory or entity of the like, can still hold and apply for a GitLab for Education license but any work completed for the benefit of a third party, or under contract for example, cannot occur on the free license.

Services: Any activities conducted by a consulting center, super computer laboratory, or entity that provides services for the benefit of a third party are not acceptable under the free license.

Issuing licenses to students

At this time, GitLab does not issue licenses directly to students as part of the GitLab for Education Program.

Students are welcome to encourage their educational institution to apply to the program directly.

Students can access a free subscription for GitLab.com or a free download of our core self-managed offering.

Students can also apply for a 30-day trial if they would like to test more advanced features of GitLab.

Children under the age of 13 are not permitted to use GitLab.com (SaaS Software).

Requests for support

When we are reviewing opportunities or requests for support, we must be able to answer yes to each of these questions to move forward with the work:

1. Will this work support, grow, and/or engage the GitLab for Education community?
1. Can it grow the skills and abilities of the education evangelist to ultimately make them a better resource to our community?
1. Is there a measurable impact on the GitLab for Education community? This can include influence on a GitLab KPI, progress on an OKR, or completion of responsibilities that are defined in the GitLab handbook.
1. Has an issue been created with the appropriate labels to define the work and assign a DRI?

If the answer to any of the above questions is "no", our team will collaborate with each other and the requestor to do one of the following actions:

1. Make adjustments so we can take on the work.
1. Find another team that is better suited to deliver the work.
1. Come to an agreement that the work should not be done.

SECTION: marketing/developer-relations/community-programs/open-source-program/_index.md

GitLab's open source program is part of the Developer Relations team. It consists of three sub-programs:

GitLab for Open Source Program, through which qualifying open source projects receive benefits like features of GitLab Ultimate with 50,000 compute minutes for free.

Consortium Memberships, which allow us to extend GitLab's leadership in key open source initiatives, enhance GitLab's brand, and/or improve engineering alignment

How to reach us

DRI: Nick Veenhof

Slack channel: community-programs

Email: opensource@gitlab.com

What we're working on

We manage program support requests in a dedicated internal project with its own issue queue and tracking board.

We manage program editorial work with in the open source partner editorial queue.

We track this work as part of the Developer Relations team roadmap.

See the Developer Relations project management page for more detail.

GitLab for Open Source Program

By empowering open source projects with our most advanced features, the GitLab for Open Source Program supports GitLab's mission to make the world a place where anyone can contribute. We help make GitLab the best place for open source projects to grow and thrive.

Send questions about the GitLab for Open Source Program to opensource@gitlab.com.

FAQs

What are the benefits of the GitLab for Open Source Program?

At no cost, members of the GitLab for Open Source Program receive a GitLab Ultimate subscription (self-managed or SaaS), which includes 50,000 compute minutes calculated at a program-specific cost factor.

Product support is not included as part of this subscription.

Who qualifies for the GitLab for Open Source Program?

In order to be accepted into the GitLab for Open Source Program, applicants must:

Use OSI-approved licenses for their projects: Every project in the applying namespace must be published under an OSI-approved open source license.

Not seek profit: An organization can accept donations to sustain its work, but it can't seek to make a profit by selling services, by charging for enhancements or add-ons, or by other means.

Be publicly visible: Both the applicant's GitLab.com group or self-managed instance and source code must be publicly visible and publicly available.

Please note: Benefits of the GitLab for Open Source Program apply to a namespace.

To qualify for the program, every project in an applicant's namespace must carry an OSI-approved open source license.

We make the following exceptions to our eligibility criteria:

Federal Exception Policy

Unfortunately, we are not able to accept all open source projects that are affiliated with the US Federal government.

Projects that are affiliated must work with a Sales representative to see if they qualify.

Private Project Exceptions

In some cases, we allow program members to host a small number of private projects if those projects contain sensitive data.

Members should send an email to opensource@gitlab.com in order to discuss this exemption.

Program members must obtain written permission from the GitLab Open Source Program team in order to use their licenses outside of program requirements.

By default we allow a namespace to have a single private project besides the public ones, for security needs.

Strategic Qualification Exceptions

We may make strategic exceptions to our program requirements.

A GitLab Sales team member must make this request on behalf of an open source project.

To request an exception, write an email to opensource@gitlab.com with details about which requirement do you want to bypass and why.

What are the terms of the GitLab for Open Source Program?

Upon acceptance to the GitLab for Open Source Program, all program members are subject to the

GitLab for Open Source Program Agreement.

How does someone apply for the GitLab for Open Source Program?

Applicants should submit the form on the GitLab Customers Portal.

The page is only available for signed-in users. Each customer can freely sign in (or sign up) on the Customers Portal through their existing GitLab account.

Depending on where an open source project is hosted (on GitLab.com or a Self-managed instance), the form requests different information from an applicant.

After submission and passing checks, the applicant receives an email with further instructions.

How are GitLab for Open Source Program applications processed?

The GitLab for Open Source team processes applications according to the Community Programs application workflow.

For additional information on program-specific workflows, see the Open Source Program Workflows page.

Must members of the GitLab for Open Source Program renew their memberships?

Yes.

Program members must renew their memberships annually.

If they don't renew, their accounts will be downgraded.

Subscriptions granted under the GitLab for Open Source Program do not auto-renew.

We recommend that applicants begin the renewal process at least one month in advance of their renewal dates to ensure sufficient processing time.

How does someone renew their membership in the GitLab for Open Source Program?

Subscriptions granted under the GitLab for Open Source Program do not auto-renew.

To request a renewal, program members should complete the program application.

The team will use this form to determine whether the entity applying for renewal still meets the program's eligibility criteria.

Whether applying to the program for the first time or renewing a pre-existing membership, applicants complete the same form.

The person claiming the renewal for the subscription must be the same person who created the subscription for this open source project or organization in the GitLab Customer Portal.

If a different person wishes to initiate the renewal, the existing owner needs to transfer ownership of the Customers Portal account.

If the existing owner is no longer able to transfer ownership or renew, the project should open a support ticket to change the owner of the subscription before initiating renewal.

After completing application form, verified applicants receive a verification email with instructions for activating their subscriptions.

Where can members of the GitLab for Open Source Program find support?

While GitLab for Open Source Program benefits do not include product support, program members can receive help with GitLab in a number of ways. In general, we recommend the following:

Send questions or issues requiring immediate attention or sensitive information to the GitLab for Open Source Program team at opensource@gitlab.com.

Review GitLab Docs for answers to general product-related questions.

Post questions in the GitLab for Open Source category of the GitLab Forum, where community members and GitLab team members can review and discuss them.

File bug reports and breaking behaviors as issues for product teams to review and address.

Program management resources

Updating the program application page

When seeking to edit the GitLab for Open Source application page, find the appropriate file at `data/solutionchildren/join.yml`.

Managing the program support queue

Members of the Community Programs team use GitLab Service Desk to manage program members' support requests.

Because these requests often contain sensitive data and personally identifying information, we file them as issues in a private project.

When a new request arrives, Service Desk will label the issue as OS Program Support::Intake.

When the ticket is under active review and remediation with a team member, that team member should assign it to themselves and add the OS Program Support::Open label.

When a support issue is pending program member review and/or additional details, it should receive the OS Program Support::Pending label.

When a support issue has been resolved, it should receive the OS Program Support::Closed label.

View the current status of all open program support issues on a private project board.

Consortium Memberships and Sponsorships

GitLab's open source program team also oversees GitLab's representation and participation in select industry consortia, as well as GitLab's sponsorship of select open source community events.

FAQs

What is a consortium?

We define "consortium" as a group created to further some technological cause.

In the context of open source software, a prototypical consortium would be the Linux Foundation (LF), a non-profit organization founded in 2000 as a merger between Open Source Development Labs and the Free Standards Group, which hosts and promotes collaborative development of open source software projects.

Why is consortium marketing important?

Consortia are influential leaders in their respective ecosystems, as they often host conferences and underwrite programs that influence global conversations about particular technological developments.

Participating in consortia enhances GitLab's brand and helps align GitLab's engineering efforts with global efforts and trends.

How does GitLab participate in consortium activities?

While select consortium memberships fall within the purview (and budget) of GitLab's open source program, the Developer Advocacy team focuses on consortium marketing, working to integrate GitLab's overall community message and technical perspective into the most appropriate and effective industry conversations.

How can I recommend GitLab get involved in a consortium?

You can open an issue in the Consortium Memberships project. When you do, please use the membership-evaluation template to structure your issue.

Open source program team members will evaluate your application using the following criteria. When we review the application, we'll assess it with these considerations in mind:

Awareness opportunities
Ease of collaboration
Contribution and hiring pool

| Considerations | What we're interested in | Questions we're asking |

| -----| ----- | -----|

| Awareness opportunities | Size of the organization
Frequency and impact of marketing opportunities
| How many authenticated and non-authenticated users are visiting organization's website monthly?
How many people are part of the organization's community?
What sorts of marketing and communication channels (social media platforms, newsletters, blogs, events) does the organization use?
Will GitLab appear in those official channels? How prominent would our placement be? |

| Ease of collaboration | Access to a dedicated marketing resources/point person
Time-to-execute for standard communication types | Does the organization have marketing capacity?
How mature is the organization's brand and marketing portions?
How quickly can this organization produce a resource (e.g., a case study)? A week? A month? A quarter?
How responsive is the person in charge of the relationship?
Is marketing handled by volunteers or paid employees? |

| Contribution and hiring pool | Size of contributor/member base
Overall community/member activity
Frequency of community contribution
Rate of adoption | How active is the community the organization is attempting to foster?
Does the organization have a sense of its community's health?
Do we see hiring opportunities to recruit from the community's talent pool?
What is the growth of the community or foundation itself?
Do we see job opportunities within that software ecosystem (are people hiring contributors from this community in general)?
How can GitLab contribute in ways that align with our interests?
Can GitLab participate in the project's roadmap in ways that creates mutual value? |

In which consortia is GitLab involved?

We are currently members of the following consortia:

Cloud Native Computing Foundation
Fintech Open Source Foundation
InnerSource Commons
Linux Foundation
Open Source Security Foundation
TODO Group

Complete details of GitLab's activities with these groups are available in the Consortium Memberships project.

Note that because this project contains sensitive data and personally identifying information, it is only accessible to GitLab team members.

Program management resources

Elections for Board of Directors opportunities

Some of the consortia in which we participate allow members to run for their respective Boards of Directors.

Anyone interested in becoming more involved in any of the consortia GitLab supports should visit the Consortium Memberships project and open an issue.

Review the information below if you're thinking of seeking nomination for (or election to) consortium positions.

Internal nominations

The Developer Relations team tracks consortium board elections closely.

In the event that an election opportunity arises, the team will create a confidential issue in the Consortium Memberships project to discuss it.

The team will determine which GitLab team member(s) could serve effectively in the elected position.

Their considerations prioritize the following criteria:

Expertise and experience with the technologies we hope to influence as part of the organization's board

Pre-existing relationships with current board members and member organizations that could aid electability

Tenure at GitLab and seniority in role at GitLab

The team will connect individually with the top candidate it feels would best suit the role given the above requirements, then ask that individual about their willingness and availability to serve.

Candidates should consider the required time investment and their capacity for attending board meetings and representing GitLab at consortium events.

Should the candidate wish to serve, the team will confirm the selection with the marketing organization leadership, then work with the nominee to prepare all requisite paperwork and craft a nomination statement.

The team maintains a list of candidacy statements for reference and aid in this process. Should the candidate defer due to time or other constraints, the team will connect with the next person on the priority list given the above criteria.

Campaigning

Once GitLab candidates are nominated, the Developer Relations team can help them campaign for their positions.

We'll make other GitLab team members aware of the election and equip them to assist your campaign, too (e.g., by announcing the campaign on the whats-happening-at-gitlab Slack channel).

Promoting

The social media team is able to promote elections notification news.

They simply need a place to point people, preferably an updated webpage that lists the board of directors or a social media post from the organization that mentions the election results.

Event sponsorships

GitLab's Developer Relations team maintains a small budget for sponsorship of events that allow GitLab to engage with open source communities.

We typically allocate this budget for local and regional community-driven events that GitLab's corporate events and field marketing teams have not already agreed to sponsor and staff.

We prefer to sponsor events at which multiple open source projects and communities are present.

The open source program team tracks event participation in the Open Source Marketing project on GitLab.

To suggest an open source event sponsorship, open an issue in this project and use the event issue template to file your request.

Event organizers and consortium leads working with GitLab will find GitLab's brand-related assets (such as logo files, press release boilerplate, and trademark information) in GitLab's press kit.

Measuring our success

Our team measures the success of our work in the following ways.

Program enrollment

The GitLab for Open Source Program team monitors the health and vitality of the program by tracking overall program membership and members' annual renewal rates. We do this via the following Tableau dashboard:

Community Dashboard

The dashboard reports the Number of Licenses the program is currently administering, the number of Unique Accounts associated with the program, and the Institution Renewed rate.

GitLab team members with SAFE access to Tableau can view this reports for additional details.

Program member GitLab utilization

The GitLab for Open Source Program furnishes insights about the ways open source projects and communities use GitLab's various features and functions.

We therefore track members' overall utilization of GitLab where possible.

We do this via Salesforce according to the following reports:

Open Source Program Utilization

Open Source Program Seats

GitLab team members with access to Salesforce and Gainsight can view these reports for additional details.

Support ticket volume and response

The GitLab for Open Source Program team manages program support tickets in a dedicated private GitLab project with corresponding Service Desk. Because the team is dedicated to providing quick, helpful service to program members, we measure both the volume of tickets we receive quarterly and the average time required to respond to those tickets. We do this via the following Tableau dashboard:

Community Programs Support Tickets Dashboard

GitLab team members with access to Tableau can view this reports for additional details.

Impact on Hacker News

We also track (and, when necessary, participate in) Hacker News discussions related to both our open source programs and partners.

Examples include:

2023-12-08: Arch Linux bugtracker migration to GitLab completed

2022-06-14: GitLab Now the Main Development Platform for Wine

2020-10-28: Wikimedia is moving to GitLab

2020-06-29: The KDE community is moving to GitLab

2018-05-31: Gnome has moved to GitLab

2019-09-30: KDE is adopting GitLab

2017-11-15: Debian and GNOME announce plans to migrate communities to GitLab

2017-05-16: A proposal to move Gnome to GitLab

SECTION: marketing/developer-relations/community-programs/startups-program/_index.md

About

GitLab is committed to supporting the startup community, and we are excited to announce the expansion of our GitLab for Startups program.

Our goal has always been to help businesses of all sizes streamline their development processes and improve collaboration, and we recognize the unique challenges that startups face.

The GitLab for Startups program is meant to help qualifying startups access to GitLab's most advanced features.

GitLab's startups program is part of the Developer Relations team.
View the program application page for additional details.

How to reach us

DRI: @akarsten1

Slack channel: startups-program-questions

Email: startups@gitlab.com

How we manage the program

Related issues can be filed on the Startups program board

Current program offer

Our expanded offering is tiered specifically according to applicants' phases of growth.
Below you will find the criteria and benefits of each tier.

Seed Stage

Eligibility

Pre-Seed or Seed Stage; up to \$5 million in funding

Funding must have been raised externally

New customers only

Benefits

During Year One, members receive:

Free Ultimate licence for a year (SaaS or self-managed) up to 20 seats

Support not included

During Year Two, you'll receive:

50% discount on any tier; up to 20 seats

Early Stage

Eligibility

Currently series A or Series B; up to \$20 million in funding

Funding must have been raised externally

New customers only

Benefits

During Year One, you'll receive:

50% discount on any tier; up to 20 seats
Support not included

During Year Two, you'll receive:

25% discount on any tier; up to 20 seats

How to Quote

When creating a quote at either 50% (Seed Y2, Early Y1) or 25% discount (Early Y2), please follow the below steps;

Create the quote

Request approval from Alex Karsten or Hugh Walker on Chatter on the opp

Once approval granted, request Deal Desk's approval override by submitting an Internal Support Case in Salesforce. Use the below template, and amend it as required.

Deals Desk, please provide approval override for this Startup opportunity;

Startup Program - Seed Y2 - 50% Discount

Startup Program - Early Y1 - 50% Discount

Startup Program - Early Y2 - 25% Discount

Please also;

Disable Auto-Renewal

Disable QSRs

Change the Opportunity Order Type from 3. Growth to 1. First Order (if Seed Y2 or Early Y1)

Note: include chatter approval message in the case.

Additional information

Upon acceptance, program members are subject to the GitLab Subscription Agreement. The decision to issue a GitLab Startup license is always at the sole discretion of GitLab.

For self-hosted instances, users must enable usage and analytics features.

SECTION: marketing/developer-relations/contributor-success/_index.md

Common Links

| | |

|-----|-----|

| GitLab Team Handle | @gitlab-org/developer-relations/contributor-success |

| Slack Channel | contributor-success & contributor-success-confidential |

| Slack Channels from initiatives that we help drive| leadingorganizations |

| Team Boards | gitlab-org/-/boards/4296693 |
| Issue Tracker | gitlab-org/developer-relations/contributor-success/team-task |

Strategy

This team directly follows the strategy outlined in our open source growth strategy.

Mission

The goal of the team is to lead the contributor program, support & attract customers who co-create GitLab with us and increase the efficiency of our contribution process through technical and process improvements to sustain our ambition of 170+ contributors with merged MRs per month to GitLab. This is aligned with GitLab's mission to enable everyone to contribute to and co-create the software that powers our world and is aligned with the 3-year internal company strategy.

FY26 Direction

In FY26 we will continue our focus on the following key initiatives

- Increasing MRARR through our GitLab co-create program. Aligned with our value results for customers
 - Growing the number of unique new monthly contributors, code and non-code. Aligned with our open source growth strategy
 - Reducing Open Community MR Age (OCMA). Aligned with our open source growth strategy
 - Shifting the focus towards higher valued contributions aligned with our product roadmap.
- Aligned with our open source growth strategy

As an internal priority we'll focus on improving project & issue scoping and prioritization per the FY25Q3 retrospective.

Any engineering work required to reach these goals is within limits. For example, GDK work, POC's of Duo, Triage-ops refactors with AI assisted classifications and more.

Unique New Monthly Contributors

1. Minimize reliance on human interaction
1. Reduce volatility through introducing automations that drive contributions forward automatically
1. Capitalize on untapped potential - MRs that have become stale but have received a seal of approval as useful addition to GitLab.
1. Invest into attracting more new contributors

Open Community MR Age (OCMA)

1. Minimize reliance on human factors that contribute to a large standard deviation
1. Identify & drive tooling improvements to decrease OCMA

Co-Create

The GitLab Co-Create program is a cross-functional initiative that is led by the Contributor Success team, in combination with Product & Engineer. More GitLab specific instructions can be found in our cocreate handbook page.

Team Responsibilities

- Improve GitLab's Contribution Efficiency and merge request coaching process.
- Contribute as a merge request coach in one or more specialties by providing guidance to community contributors on technical and non-technical aspects.
- Be a point of escalation for community contributors and identify GitLab DRIs to resolve blockers.
- Organize community contributors into community teams and ensure their success.
- Track contribution delivery of the Community Contributors and Cohorts.
- Nominate impactful community contributors and contributions for recognition.
- Select and recognize a GitLab Notable Contributor for each release post
- Collaborate closely with our Marketing counterparts and Core team.
- Improve community recognition system, awards and engineering assistance in collaboration with the Developer Relations team.
- Participate in GitLab's overall open source outreach events and processes.
- Triage community issues to be picked up by the community or GitLab team members
- Triage community merge requests from the daily merge request coach report
- Review merge requests assigned as a merge request coach or from the reviewer roulette

Team Members

{{< team-by-departments "Contributor Success" >}}

File an issue

gitlab-org/gitlab

All issues that relate to the Open Source project GitLab and that can serve to enhance the contributor flow and are public by nature should be created here by default. We aim to not have any distinction between contributors or GitLab team-members for which we expect by default that everyone should be able to contribute to.

- Location: gitlab-org/gitlab
- Required label: Contributor Success

gitlab-org/developer-relations/contributor-success/team-task

All issues that relate to the inner working of the company GitLab, including specific internal team workings, onboardings-issues or issues relating to customers that should be separated from the Open Source project GitLab can be placed here.

- Location: gitlab-org/developer-relations/contributor-success/team-task
- Required label: Contributor Success

Project Management

- Our team project is our single source of truth for all tasks & backlog.
- Epics that contain cross-functional work across multiple departments can be created at the gitlab-org level.

OKRs

OKRs are not public. But rest assured, we have these goals always in mind, including in our quarterly objectives & key results.

Performance Indicators

We have the following Performance Indicators

Unique Wider Community Contributors per Month

Unique Wider Community Contributors per Month

- Activities:
 - Partnership with Developer Relations team.
 - Hold community office hours.
 - Hold hackathons.
 - Allow running of QA tests from forks.
 - Shorten the CI runtime for community contributions (in forks).

More details can be found in the Unique Wider Community Contributors per Month Marketing PI section

Open Community MR Age (OCMA)

- Activities:
 - Shorten CI time
 - Improve Community Contribution automation
 - Enable running QA tests on forks
 - Increase number of coaches
 - Partner with Engineering Productivity to provide feedback to improve contribution tooling (currently GDK).

More details can be found in the OCMA Developer Relations PI section

MRARR

- Activities:
 - Reach out to top tier enterprise customers
 - Help take-on inactive customer contribution to completion & merge
 - Partner with CSMs to enlist and facilitate contribution from customers
 - Launch contribution materials targeting large enterprises
 - Partner with Developer Relations team (David P)
 - Maintain a list of known contributors with a mapping to their accounts and the accounts ARR

contribution as input to this KPI

Please see Contributing Orgs tracker for details how to onboard or offboard a GitLab account from being linked to a customer account, and being counted into the MRARR metric.

More details can be found at the MRARR Developer Relations PI section

How we plan work

The team uses the Contributor Success Kanban board.
Issues must:

- Be created in the gitlab-org group
- Have the Contributor Success label
- Have at least 1 workflow label from the list below

We use priority labels to designate focus areas per quarter.

Workflow labels

- workflow::validation backlog: Issues start in our backlog so the team can validate for effort vs. impact against our KPIs, OKRs and team strategies.
- workflow::refinement: These issues are validated and refined through planning and team discussion before they are marked as ready. Issues should have an Implementation Plan section before moving to the next workflow stage.
- workflow::ready for development: These issues are ready to be picked up, have an Implementation Plan section and a priority label.
- workflow::in dev: Issues actively being worked on this quarter.
- workflow::blocked: Issues currently blocked. The description must note the blocker and include a link to issues that would unblock.
- workflow::complete: Issues that are resolved after implementation. These should be highlighted in reports back to the team and DevRel department before being closed.

Priority labels

- priority::1 (highest priority): Issues critical to the current quarter's KPIs and OKRs, or urgent bugs blocking work for contributors.
- priority::2: Issues aligned with current quarter's goals but without urgent due dates.
- priority::3: Issues that support long-term objectives without impact on current quarter goals.
- priority::4 (lowest priority): Issues that bring incremental value but can wait for additional capacity.

How to pick issues

Team members should select issues from workflow::ready for development based on priority label. While the team focuses on priority::1 and priority::2 issues for the current quarter, sometimes it makes sense to pick up a lower-priority task between larger projects. We are guided by GitLab's values on efficiency and iteration to act as managers of one when choosing tasks.

Contributor Success Retrospective

Every quarter we hold an asynchronous retrospective (example) using GitLab issues.

Questions asked are

- What should we start?
- What should we stop?
- What should we continue?

Contributor Success' DRI is responsible for creating an issue in the team tracker gitlab-org/developer-relations/contributor-success/team so that it can be easily retrieved in the future.

Contributor Success' DRI is responsible for digesting the feedback and selecting one, after votes, issue to take into the new quarter.

Contributor Success stand-up

The purpose of this stand-up is to collaborate between teams members of Contributor Success. This is a team-specific meeting to check in on blockers, progress and ways to think differently & iterate towards our goals.

- Agenda: <<https://docs.google.com/document/d/1chlzCdG1CNRrRRuYR7c7OWBF1mBxKFTJoXyP2HLt4Eeading=h.o6qzal1u0b7i>>

Contributor Success reading list

A curated list of external resources for improving open source community relations and the contributor experience:

- Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion in Open Source
- Working in Public: The Making and Maintenance of Open Source Software
- Growing Your Contributors
- Building Welcoming Communities
- Open Source Survey
- Non-code contributions are the secret to open source success
- The secrets to onboarding new open source contributors
- The privilege of free time in Open Source
- Good first issues don't exist

Promotion

We recommend adding an event to the GitLab Team Meetings calendar (internal) and creating:

- An event in the GitLab Virtual Community Events meetup group.
- An event on the GitLab Community Discord.
- An agenda (using Google Docs, with public editor access so everyone with the link can collaborate).

NOTE: Make sure Zoom links have the password embedded.

SECTION: marketing/developer-relations/contributor-success/community-appreciation.md

Let's Award Contributors Together

We want to recognize amazing contributions from the wider community with GitLab swags. All GitLab team members and members of the wider community are encouraged to nominate others or themselves (for campaigns such as myfirstMRmerge).

Include Everyone

If you think that someone deserves a swag prize, nominate them!

If you reached an important campaign milestone (e.g. myfirstMRmerged) with your contribution, you can also nominate yourself!

Eligibility

Anyone who you feel deserves an extra special something for their contribution, comment, or community involvement is eligible for swag.

This can include, (but is not limited to):

Great contributions to the GitLab product via issues or merge requests

Representing the voice of GitLab at a speaking event, with a blog post, at a Meetup, or with a presentation

Achieving the myfirstMRmerged milestone

Leaving a great answer on our community forum

Posting a great answer to on a GitLab StackOverflow or GitLab subreddit question

Bug Bounty reporters who submitted a quality report that did not qualify for monetary reward in our Bug Bounty program.

For cases not listed above, use your best judgement, and create a merge request to add new cases to the list.

Eligibility for Self Nomination

If you've contributed to our community or reached an important campaign milestone, you're eligible to self nominate for GitLab swag. Note that to self nominate, you must provide relevant links and evidence of your contributions to be evaluated by the GitLab team.

| Contribution | Notes for Self Nomination|

| ----- | ----- |

| myfirstMRmerged | Must include link the merged MR |

| Community Blog Post | Must include link to published blog post |

| GitLab Forum Answer | Must include link to high quality answer provided on the GitLab Forum |

| Meetup/Presentation | Must include link to the meetup/event page |

Nomination Process

The following process can be used either

To nominate a wider community member for swag, or nominate yourself for swag, please fill the nomination form. Make sure to include links that show your community contribution ready before you send the form.

That's it! Contributor Success team members will be in touch with the person nominated on how to get the swag!

The form is reviewed weekly, and at a minimum each month, by Contributor Success, and you can check the status of each nomination in column K of the form's spreadsheet (only for GitLab Team members).

Form Processing by Developer Relations Team

1. The Developer Relations team will review the nomination request and send the merchandise to the wider community member.
2. If the application is valid, communicate the giveaway link and code to the community member via email.

Templates for Sending Swag Links

Email Template

markdown

Hi [NAME]!

The GitLab team has noticed the awesome support you provide on [Social Channel] to users asking questions about GitLab.

We'd love to recognize your efforts with some free GitLab swag!

The link below will take you directly to an order form where you can choose your favorite GitLab swag item.

[Giveaway Link] / [Code]

If you have any questions, don't hesitate to reach out. Thanks for your contributions to the

GitLab community!

Finding Community Member Contact Information

This section outlines the strategies that GitLab team member might use to contact community members during this process

Always default to email communication. Email information of a contributor, if not known, can be requested from the Director of Contributor Success (only for Developer Relations team members)

- Create a confidential issue with the list of GitLab usernames

- Explain the source of the GitLab usernames

- Add the communication method where you would like to receive the contact details

- Emails given will only be the main email present in the GitLab profile.

Sustainability and Swag Alternatives

We love swag, but there is an impact on the environment.

In an effort to offset this, we now offer the option of planting trees instead.

Contributor Success process the tree orders via Tree Nation using credentials from their 1Password vault.

SECTION: marketing/developer-relations/contributor-success/community-contributors-workflows.md

Workflows

Real-time Communications

A GitLab contributor room is available on Discord for people interested in contributing to GitLab. This is open to everyone to join and is a good place for community members to network and help each other.

Issues

Contributor links

To make it clear and easy for everyone to contribute, a triage-ops processor adds contributor links to issues to enable customers/community members to label, close and assign themselves.

GitLab team members can suppress these links by adding the suppress-contributor-links label.

Labeling issues for community contributors

See guidance on seeking wider community contributions and the criteria for quick win issues.

Community issues workflow manual process

See the partial issue triage checklist.

Merge Requests

Wider community merge requests are MRs opened by a person that's not present on <https://about.gitlab.com/company/team/> (excluding any bot, service account users or individual contractors).

Labels

- The Community contribution label is automatically applied by the GitLab Bot to MRs submitted by wider community members.
 - You can see the list of MRs in [gitLab-org](#) list of merge requests.
 - Learn more about the cadence and conditions for this automation.
- The 1st contribution label is added to first-time contributions. Every time a contributor is opening a merge request under the [gitlab-org](#) namespace for the first time, the label 1st contribution is automatically applied to the merge request.
 - You can see the list of MRs in [gitlab-org](#) list of merge requests.
 - First-time contributors are also awarded a gift as our way to say thanks.

Triage reports

See Community-related triage reports.

Scheduled workflow automation

See Community-related scheduled workflow automation.

Reactive workflow automation

See Community-related reactive workflow automation.

Merge request coaches

Merge request coaches are available to help contributors with their MRs. This includes:

- Identifying reviewers for the MR.
- Answering questions from contributors.
- Educating contributors on the contribution acceptance criteria.
- Or completing the MR if the contributor is unresponsive or unable to complete.
 - In that case, the coach will finish label will be added to the MR and the coach will either directly push new commits to the MR, or re-create a new MR with the original changes.
- Contributors can mention the coaches in their MRs by typing `@gitlab-org/coaches`.

The list of current merge request coaches can be found in the team page by selecting `Merge Request Coach` in the department filter.

There is also the mr-coaching channel in GitLab Slack if GitLab team members have any questions related to community contributions.

More information on merge request coaches (including how to become a merge request coach) can be found in the MR coach lifecycle page.

Contributing to the GitLab Enterprise Edition (EE)

For community contributors

To contribute to any of the paid features in GitLab Enterprise Edition, community contributors will need to add a license to their GDK. If they don't already have a license, they can get a free trial for 30 days (choose the Self-Managed option). If they cannot complete their work in 30 days, a new EE license for 90 days for a limited number of users (100) can be issued.

Renewal of this license:

- In the event of active contributions in the previous license cycle, this license can be renewed for a further year.
- If there have been no active contributions in the previous license cycle, a 90 day renewal can be granted.

Contributors will need to create an request in this project to request their license: Wider Community Contributor License Request.

Processing Enterprise Edition (EE) License Requests

To be completed by a GitLab team member:

Prerequisites

- Access to Zendesk support portal, requested via Zendesk Global Light Agent form.

Process

- Access the GitLab support form. (Internal link for team members only)
- Select "GitLab L&R request for global customers" as the initial option
- Choose "Wider community license" from the subsequent dropdown
- Fill out the required fields provided in the request issue.
 - Contact information: Use the requesting contributor's information
- Other required fields:
 - True-up: 0
 - Priority of request: Low
 - License type: Ultimate (unless otherwise specified)
 - Expiration date:
 - 90 days for new contributors
 - 1 year for renewals
 - Use Nick's email as approving manager if it is a 1 year renewal
- In "What is the reason for the license being issued?" specify Wider community contributor EE

license request and add a link to the license request issue.

- Add a public comment to the request issue indicating the request has been submitted
- The support form, when submitted, gives the user a link to the pipeline that "creates" the request in Zendesk. Save the link to this pipeline in an internal comment in case there are any issues that need investigating later.

The Support team will respond following this workflow within 24 hours.

Close

After license is provisioned:

- Add a public comment on the issue with confirmation that the license request has been provisioned
- Add a confidential comment with a screenshot of the "Private Note" included in the email sent to you by support
- Close the issue

DCO and CLA Guidance

All external contributions to GitLab are subject to the GitLab DCO or CLA, depending on where the contribution is made and on whose behalf.

Instructions for corporate contributors to enter into an overarching Corporate CLA covering all contributions made on their behalf are set out on the DCO-CLA page.

Corporate CLA Contributor Management

Contributor success has been assisting the Legal and Corporate Affairs team with the creation and maintenance of a namespace under which GitLab can maintain lists of users associated with Corporate CLAs.

This group can be found here: <https://gitlab.com/gitlab-corporate-cla>

Adding a new group

Adding a new corporate group under this namespace is as follows:

1. Create a subgroup with a name/slug that matches the organization's name.
1. Ensure the visibility of the new subgroup is set to Private.
1. Once created, edit the subgroup (Settings > General) and add the text Approved contributors for XXXXX under the GitLab Corporate CLA to the group description.
1. Confirm/set the following settings:
 1. General > Permissions and Group Features
 1. Permissions - Group mentions are disabled
 1. Wiki - Group-level wiki is disabled
 1. Roles allowed to create projects - No one
 1. Membership - Users can request access (disabled)
1. Add the user account of the Organization's designated user manager(s) to the group as Owner.

(under Subgroup information > Members)

1. Remove your user account as a direct member of the subgroup. (Under Group owners, filter for Membership = Direct, click the 'kebab menu', select 'Leave Group')

Educational materials

1. Gitpod with GDK - Introduction (video)

1. Gitpod with GDK - Setup (video)

Leading Organizations

How do I add an organization or a user to an organization?

- Navigate to the Contributing Org Tracker.
- Go to the MRARR Organization tab.
- If a user is not listed here, you can add it to the respective row, or add a new row at the bottom with the same structure.

How do I enable the Leading Organizations program benefits for organizations

- Navigate to the Contributing Org Tracker.
- Go to the Leading Organization tab.
- Add the organization to the list with the exact same name as found in the MRARR Organization tab.
- Make sure you enter an entry date & current MR count from the last 3 months so we can look back and understand their performance over time.

How do I stop the Leading Organizations program benefits for organizations

- Navigate to the Contributing Org Tracker.
- Go to the Leading Organization tab.
- Enter the exit date next to the respective organization that should no longer receive the benefits.

Caution: If an organization reaches the threshold it will be auto-enrolled in the program for receiving the review-time SLO.

GitLab Notable Contributor Selection Process

See GitLab Notable Contributor Selection Process.

Contributor Thanks messages

The Contributor Success team has been regularly thanking GitLab team members and Wider community members for active participation in Merge Requests. At the moment, this takes the form of:

- A weekly thanks message in the thanks channel in slack - Thanking GitLab team members for participation in Community Contribution Merge Requests.
- A weekly thanks message in the thanks channel in discord - Thanking wider community members

for having MRs merged, as well as participating in other's MRs that were merged.
- A monthly thread on the forum, with the weekly posts from discord crossposted.

These messages are generated with the help of a script that is being maintained and iterated on by the Contributor Success Team. The script runs on a Monday morning, and injects the messages into the contributor-success channel in slack.

Weekly message posting

To post the messages:

- Copy the appropriate message from the contributor-success Slack channel into the appropriate thanks channel. The Scope: GitLab Team mode message goes to Slack thanks and the Scope: Wider Community mode message goes to Discord thanks.
- Verify the content is applicable to the audience (i.e. the internal message in slack, etc)
- Validate any automated user handle expansions to verify the correct person and add missing user handles.
- Send the message!
- Post the wider community message on the forum, too, under the Community category, with the addition of a crosslink to the Discord post.
 - If this is the first post since a release, open a new topic with the title: GitLab x.xx Release Community Thanks and use the tag thanks.
 - Otherwise, add a new message on the existing thread.
- Update the assignee of the tracking issues and due dates.

Tracking issues:

- Internal Weekly message
- Wider Community message

Manual execution

In the event you need to generate the message(s) manually, you will need to follow these prerequisite steps:

1. Check out the latest main branch of the toolbox project: `git clone git@gitlab.com:gitlab-org/developer-relations/contributor-success/toolbox.git`
1. Change directory to the checked out project: `cd toolbox`
1. Install the required gems: `bundle install`

To generate the internal weekly message:

1. Execute the script following the 'weekly' example here
1. Paste the resulting message into thanks in slack, taking care to note the keystrokes: Paste this message into slack using `Cmd-v`, then apply formatting using `Cmd-Shift-F`
1. Double check the message that was pasted - making sure to edit @ mentions where slack has 'helpfully' incorrectly linked the user.
1. If exceptions were raised in the script for missing managers attempt to track down the acting manager or the next level up report and manually cc them in the message.
1. Send the message and join in the celebrations!

1. Record the PI numbers from the message in the tracking issue if necessary.
1. Update the assignee of the tracking issue and due date.

To generate the external community message:

1. Execute the script following the 'wider' example here
1. Make sure to check the duration for which you want to run the report.
1. Paste the resulting message into thanks in discord.
1. Double check the message that was pasted - to ensure the users/names all look 'right'.
1. Send the message and join in the celebrations!
1. Record the PI numbers from the message in the tracking issue if necessary.
1. Update the assignee of the tracking issue and due date.

Organizing and promoting events

Event planning

- Draft an agenda before the meeting, including (make sure the document is open to anyone with the link)
 - Roll call, introductions
 - Various topics
 - Open floor for the community to bring topics
- Include instructions on how to join
 - Link to zoom (or any other video platform)
- Add the event to the Developer Advocacy team calendar. If you are not a GitLab Team Member, ask a member of the Developer Relations team to add the event to the calendar.
- Follow the instructions below for social support or open a request at the Code Contributor's planning repo.

Social

- Draft a short action-oriented copy like: "Join the upcoming GitLab hackathon (link) on the N."
- Share the message on the following channels at least 2 weeks before, 1 week, and a day before the event:
 - Twitter: use your account but mention @gitlab (note: never share a Zoom link on Twitter)
 - GitLab Community Discord

Event platforms

- Ask John Coghlan for adding the event on meetup.com.
- Add the event on GitLab Events page.

Hackathons

There will be a quarterly Hackathon for GitLab community members to come together to work on merge requests, participate in tutorial sessions, and support each other on the GitLab Discord. Agenda, logistics, materials, recordings, and other information for Hackathons will be available on the GitLab Community Hackathon page.

The event planning will be done following the Hackathon issue template in the GitLab Hackathon project.

GitLab teams are encouraged to use the following Hackathon issue template to plan and prepare.

Virtual hackathons/hackathon-in-a-box

We also encourage wider community members to organize events to encourage and support new contributors to GitLab. This could be done as a part of in-person or virtual GitLab meetups.

If wider community members are interested in including a hackathon as a part of a meetup, ask them to include this information when they open a meetup issue. Contributor Success team members will get in touch with the organizer and provide the necessary resources to support the event.

Some of the available resources can be found in the hackathon-in-a-box folder, GDK tutorials playlist, etc. The program manager should also work with the organizer to create a list of issues that are good for first-time/inexperienced contributors and share the list with participants prior to the event. There should also be coordination with the organizer on GitLab merchandise that can be distributed to anyone who creates a Merge Request during the event.

Community office hours

To facilitate communication between the wider community and GitLab team members, product teams may host community office hours. The purpose of these office hours is to gather wider community feedback on product/development, discuss wider community contributions, review MR backlog, and other topics. Office hour related issues or MRs will have the label Office Hours as you can see in these examples.

Calls will be open to everyone and recordings will be posted after the call. See examples of past office hours from this playlist. To make it easier for the community to find the videos, each stage should create their own office hours playlist and link to it from their handbook page.

All the community office hour calls should be added to the Developer Advocacy calendar and meetup.com group.

How to organize a community office hour call

Preparation

- Once you have a finalized date and time, add it to:
 - the meetup.com group (meetup.com account available at your GitLab's 1Password vault)
 - the developer advocacy calendar
- Update the office hour running notes doc with the Zoom URL and call details
- Announce it on Discord
- Tweet about it, tagging GitLab
- The day before the call, post reminders on Discord

Running the call

- Ask for everyone's permission to live stream the call. Then press the Live Stream on YouTube butt